

Do the grid deltas show up in the final score?

College football grid deltas, recorded before kickoff, vs the actual final margin. 131 graded games (all 2026) out of 188 saved. 'The leader' = the team a delta favors. Gap size: Small = below the median |delta|, Medium = median to 75th percentile, Large = 75th to 90th, Massive = top 10% (same tiers as the Delta Scale Report). Straight-up margin, not against the spread.

1. All deltas pooled, by gap size

GAP SIZE	n	LEADER WON	WON BY 3+	WON BY 7+	WON BY 10+	WON BY 14+	LOST BY 3+	LOST BY 7+	LOST BY 10+	LOST BY 14+	AVG MARGIN
Small	937	57%	53%	42%	35%	29%	39%	31%	24%	20%	+2.9
Medium	513	64%	60%	49%	44%	38%	32%	24%	18%	14%	+7.4
Large	321	75%	73%	67%	57%	52%	22%	17%	13%	11%	+14.3
Massive	254	78%	76%	71%	64%	58%	20%	16%	10%	7%	+17.6

Games repeat across deltas (every game has ~17 of them), so read the pooled rows as a scale, not as independent samples.

2. Vice versa: games actually decided by 3 / 7 / 10 / 14+, which way did the deltas point?

GAME DECIDED BY	GAMES	ALL DELTAS POINTING AT THE WINNER	LARGE / MASSIVE DELTAS AT THE WINNER	MASSIVE ONLY AT THE WINNER
3+ points	122	65%	78% (428 vs 123)	79% (194 vs 51)
7+ points	100	67%	80% (395 vs 96)	82% (181 vs 40)
10+ points	83	70%	84% (344 vs 67)	86% (162 vs 26)
14+ points	71	71%	86% (314 vs 51)	90% (148 vs 17)

3. Which deltas track the actual score

DELTA	n	CORRELATION WITH MARGIN	1 STD DEV OF GAP = ... PTS OF MARGIN
FEI Gap	128	+0.74	+16.7
Offensive Efficiency Delta	91	+0.60	+13.6
Passing Down Panic Delta	127	+0.59	+13.0
Net Success Rate Delta	128	+0.55	+12.5
Havoc Rate Delta	127	+0.55	+12.2
Off PPG Gap	127	+0.54	+11.9
OSR vs. DSR Delta	89	+0.52	+11.9
Line Yards Delta	127	+0.44	+9.7
Sacks Delta	127	+0.42	+9.3
Stuff Rate Delta	127	+0.36	+8.0
Total Pass Matchup Delta	127	+0.34	+7.4
TFL Delta	90	+0.33	+7.2
Open Field Yards Delta	127	+0.33	+7.2
2nd Level Yards Delta	127	+0.28	+6.1
Power Success Rate Delta	127	+0.26	+5.7
Passing Explosiveness Delta	127	+0.24	+5.3
Rushing Reality Delta	121	+0.05	+1.0

4. Each delta, by gap size

The gap ranges are in the grid's own units, so you can read them straight off the grid. Rows with fewer than 10 games are greyed out: too few to lean on.

DELTA	GAP SIZE	GAP RANGE	n	LEADER WON	WON BY 7+	WON BY 14+	LOST BY 7+	LOST BY 14+	AVG MARGIN
FEI Gap	Small	< 0.505	58	69%	47%	28%	21%	10%	+5.9
	Medium	0.505 - 0.768	34	76%	62%	53%	15%	3%	+12.6
	Large	0.768 - 1.21	20	100%	90%	75%	0%	0%	+26.1
	Massive	1.21+	16	100%	100%	88%	0%	0%	+32.9
Offensive Efficiency Delta	Small	< 25.6	39	82%	49%	33%	15%	13%	+7.0
	Medium	25.6 - 43.2	24	62%	46%	38%	25%	8%	+7.0
	Large	43.2 - 72.6	17	82%	76%	47%	12%	6%	+14.4
	Massive	72.6+	11	100%	100%	91%	0%	0%	+31.1
Passing Down Panic Delta	Small	< 0.129	60	57%	43%	33%	35%	22%	+2.8
	Medium	0.129 - 0.23	31	58%	42%	32%	26%	13%	+5.4
	Large	0.23 - 0.351	19	89%	74%	47%	0%	0%	+18.3
	Massive	0.351+	17	94%	88%	76%	0%	0%	+28.3
Net Success Rate Delta	Small	< 0.242	58	66%	48%	34%	21%	14%	+6.8
	Medium	0.242 - 0.399	31	81%	58%	39%	16%	0%	+11.4
	Large	0.399 - 0.586	22	73%	64%	55%	23%	18%	+11.3
	Massive	0.586+	17	82%	82%	76%	18%	6%	+25.6
Havoc Rate Delta	Small	< 0.0515	60	57%	40%	30%	35%	23%	+3.5
	Medium	0.0515 - 0.0828	31	58%	42%	29%	23%	13%	+3.8
	Large	0.0828 - 0.128	19	79%	74%	63%	11%	5%	+19.9
	Massive	0.128+	15	87%	87%	60%	7%	0%	+25.6
Off PPG Gap	Small	< 8.8	56	54%	43%	30%	29%	16%	+4.3
	Medium	8.8 - 15.1	35	71%	57%	40%	17%	14%	+11.0
	Large	15.1 - 23.4	20	100%	80%	55%	0%	0%	+18.9
	Massive	23.4+	16	88%	81%	75%	12%	6%	+21.4
OSR vs. DSR Delta	Small	< 0.213	42	64%	45%	33%	19%	12%	+8.0
	Medium	0.213 - 0.377	22	86%	59%	45%	5%	0%	+11.3
	Large	0.377 - 0.465	14	71%	71%	57%	21%	14%	+13.9
	Massive	0.465+	11	82%	82%	73%	18%	18%	+19.9
Line Yards Delta	Small	< 0.492	64	47%	31%	28%	42%	25%	-0.5
	Medium	0.492 - 0.935	26	62%	50%	38%	19%	4%	+10.1
	Large	0.935 - 1.38	20	70%	65%	50%	20%	15%	+15.4
	Massive	1.38+	17	76%	65%	53%	24%	12%	+13.8
Sacks Delta	Small	< 1.3	56	61%	48%	36%	23%	16%	+4.7
	Medium	1.3 - 2.4	31	65%	48%	42%	23%	16%	+9.4
	Large	2.4 - 3.76	19	84%	84%	63%	11%	5%	+19.6
	Massive	3.76+	10	80%	80%	50%	10%	0%	+15.4
Stuff Rate Delta	Small	< 0.071	57	54%	42%	26%	28%	21%	+1.7
	Medium	0.071 - 0.114	33	52%	48%	42%	39%	24%	+4.9
	Large	0.114 - 0.175	21	76%	67%	62%	19%	10%	+19.8
	Massive	0.175+	16	69%	50%	31%	12%	0%	+10.1

DELTA	GAP SIZE	[GAP] RANGE	n	LEADER WON	WON BY 7+	WON BY 14+	LOST BY 7+	LOST BY 14+	AVG MARGIN
Total Pass Matchup Delta	Small	< 84.7	53	47%	30%	25%	42%	28%	+0.7
	Medium	84.7 - 152	37	73%	49%	38%	22%	14%	+10.0
	Large	152 - 231	20	70%	60%	50%	30%	10%	+8.8
	Massive	231+	17	71%	59%	47%	29%	12%	+10.0
TFL Delta	Small	< 1.2	38	53%	47%	29%	29%	18%	+2.6
	Medium	1.2 - 2.2	24	58%	50%	42%	29%	21%	+2.5
	Large	2.2 - 3.5	11	64%	55%	36%	18%	9%	+10.9
	Massive	3.5+	11	82%	64%	45%	0%	0%	+21.0
Open Field Yards Delta	Small	< 0.847	58	48%	33%	22%	40%	24%	-1.1
	Medium	0.847 - 1.38	33	67%	55%	45%	21%	12%	+11.0
	Large	1.38 - 1.96	18	67%	67%	56%	17%	17%	+15.4
	Massive	1.96+	18	67%	61%	44%	22%	11%	+8.9
2nd Level Yards Delta	Small	< 0.325	61	56%	41%	33%	31%	25%	+2.6
	Medium	0.325 - 0.56	28	61%	39%	29%	32%	11%	+5.2
	Large	0.56 - 0.906	20	65%	60%	40%	25%	15%	+9.8
	Massive	0.906+	18	61%	56%	50%	33%	17%	+10.0
Power Success Rate Delta	Small	< 0.157	59	54%	39%	19%	34%	25%	+0.7
	Medium	0.157 - 0.266	33	61%	48%	42%	30%	24%	+6.0
	Large	0.266 - 0.388	19	53%	42%	32%	26%	11%	+4.3
	Massive	0.388+	16	75%	69%	62%	25%	19%	+12.8
Passing Explosiveness Delta	Small	< 0.175	58	50%	41%	28%	31%	19%	+2.1
	Medium	0.175 - 0.289	31	58%	39%	26%	32%	26%	+2.6
	Large	0.289 - 0.423	21	76%	62%	57%	24%	19%	+11.9
	Massive	0.423+	17	65%	65%	59%	24%	0%	+14.6
Rushing Reality Delta	Small	< 31.5	60	53%	43%	33%	38%	27%	+0.8
	Medium	31.5 - 73.2	29	38%	38%	28%	38%	31%	+0.6
	Large	73.2 - 169	21	57%	43%	29%	38%	24%	+3.0
	Massive	169+	11	55%	27%	0%	18%	9%	+0.0

How much to trust it

- **One season, about 130 games.** Per-delta gap rows hold 10 to 20 games each, so a single row can swing a lot; the pooled table and the correlations are steadier.
- **The deltas are recorded before kickoff** (first time each game is seen), so this is not flattered by the game itself.
- **Big gaps are often obvious mismatches** that the betting line already prices in. This shows the deltas track the score, not that they beat a spread.
- **This is the grid's deltas.** The Deep Dive's own deltas are a separate set and are not in this study.

Built Oct 07, 2026 from cfb_delta_history.json.